

1 HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION NO. 20

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6 A JOINT RESOLUTION OF THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE STATE OF
7 MONTANA REQUESTING THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT TO INCREASE THE HOURS OF SERVICE AT
8 MONTANA-CANADA CUSTOMS PORTS OF ENTRY.

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10 WHEREAS, the U.S. Customs and Border Protection Agency has reduced the hours of service at
11 several Montana-Canada customs ports of entry; and

12 WHEREAS, the hours of service reductions have impeded commerce and trade between Montana and
13 Canada as well as the free flow of cross-border travel for business, leisure, competitive sports, and the
14 maintenance of family ties; and

15 WHEREAS, Montana and Canada have a trading relationship that enhances the economic viability of
16 communities on both sides of the border, including \$1.2 billion in goods and services exported from Montana to
17 Canada annually; and

18 WHEREAS, Canada is Montana's number one export market, and Montana sells more goods to
19 Canada than to its next 20 largest foreign markets combined; and

20 WHEREAS, Canada has been America's most trusted ally and its friendliest and largest trading partner,
21 with bilateral trade of \$2.7 billion a day and over 300,000 people crossing the border each day.

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23 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF
24 THE STATE OF MONTANA:

25 That the 69th Montana Legislature, representing all citizens of Montana, requests the federal
26 government increase the hours of service at Montana-Canada customs ports of entry to enhance trade and
27 allow for increased cross-border travel.

28 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Secretary of State send copies of this resolution to the

1 President of the United States and to the Montana Congressional Delegation.

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